

Tip 3:

Use emoji and gifs as mimetic languages

*Mimetic = related to mimesis, i.e. related to 'showing' (not telling)

Factual storytelling on Instagram?

There are four key characteristics of compelling current affairs images on Instagram:

1. **Emotive faces** – Audiences tend to gravitate towards photos of people that capture strong emotions in situ, as they feel less filtered and more "real" than posed portraits.
2. **Teases the story** – Images that tell part of a story entice audiences to want to find out more.
3. **Provocative/gripping** – Photos that surprise or shock (within reason) stand out and make audiences think.
4. **"Feel good" factor** – Images that convey positivity in the face of adversity fit with the tone of Instagram and can motivate and inspire audiences.



Ed Conway ✓

@EdConwaySky

🖌️ WATCHING PAINT DRY IS FASCINATING 🖌️

This is a story abt car paint.

🚗 But it's abt more than that.

Its abt the world we live in:

The rise of mass production

The ascent of mass consumption

The rise & fall of economic growth

And why our productivity growth seems to have stalled



Stephen Jones ✓

@SteveJonesPA

Following

If you're just waking up, a rough approximation of the parties' local election results so far

Tories 😊

Labour 😞

Lib Dems 😞

Ukip 😞

#LE2017



BBC Wales ✓

@BBCWales

Follow



@luciejones1 emoji factfile



: Lucie Bethan Jones



: 20/03/91



: Pentyrch, Cardiff



: Singer, Actress, Model



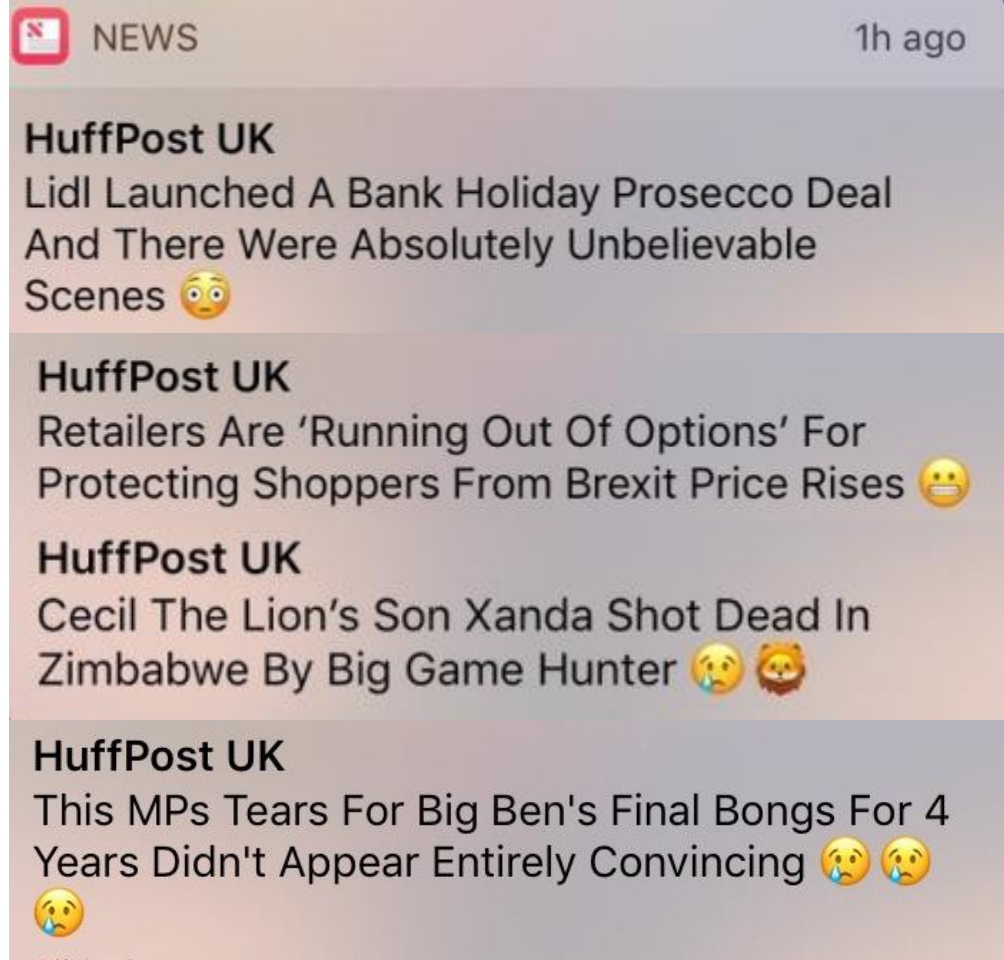
: Yup, two



<https://twitter.com/SteveJonesPA/status/860388147078868992>

<https://twitter.com/bbcwales/status/863490843143016449>

<https://x.com/EdConwaySky/status/1628068308091121665>



Emoji tips

- Use to show the **subject** (the story is about a 🦁)
 - Use as **metaphor** (💪 = power)
- Use to show the **reaction** (the story is 😭)
- **Combine** to tell a story (🏃💨🐅) aka REBUS
- Use to **direct** attention/action/list: 🧵👉📌✅1
- Guidelines: “The use of emojis can undercut an otherwise impartial post”

Edit your update for emoji

- Are there opportunities to add emoji?
- Don't add too many — one is often enough

GIFs in homepages & stories

Thousands of ticketless German football fans fight with police and try to storm into Arsenal's stadium after a day of heavy drinking in central London: Kick-off is delayed and Europa League game could now be CALLED OFF



RAMPAGE AT THE EMIRATES

[Washington Post example](#)
[LA Times example](#);
[Other examples](#)

Hitting opponents when they're down

is to finish off former featherweight champion Jose Aldo, but in down opponent is allowed time to recover in a standing eight-count.



Conor McGregor vs. Dustin Poirier (Winner: McGregor by TKO)

GIFs on social



David Gregory-Kumar ✓

@DrDavidGK

Following



Here's tonight's top VR reactions in GIF form!
More on [@bbcmtld](#) gph.is/2Fgncm8
[@DarkRealitiesVR](#)



[BBC Midlands Today tweet](#); [Reuters](#); [Vox](#)

6 ways you can create GIFs

1. Re-use existing GIF (e.g. from Giphy)
2. Create GIF from video clip (original or YouTube)
3. Image sequence (photos, graphics, charts etc.)
4. Screen capture (e.g. scrolling down page/interacting)
5. Create new meme from existing GIF (new text)
6. NEW! Animate an image [using AI tools](#)

Use: in social update, in story, listicle, email newsletter

E.g. video > gif

— — —



Created using freegifmaker.me/youtube-to-gif



Birmingham Eastside

@bhameastside

VIDEO: Watch the moment when Birmingham's French community celebrated their [#WorldCup](#) 🏆 win at [@distilleryb16](#) birminghameastside.com/2018/07/16/wat ... [#bhambc](#)



Identify a gif you can use

- Is there a video you can 'clip' as a gif?
- Can you convey an emotional reaction to the story?
- Is there a sequence of images you can animate?
- Can you animate an image using genAI?

Tip 4:
**Learn the language
of memes**

Internet memes: “a new literacy”

— — —

Meme: “An idea, piece of information, or behavior that is passed from one person to another by imitation” (Observatory on Social Media 2017)

Internet memes: a “particular idea presented as a written text, image, language ‘move,’ or some other unit of cultural ‘stuff’” (Knobel and Lankshear 2007)



What narrative function does a meme perform? Punchline/twist?

<https://www.instagram.com/reels/DP8RzkJjDHh/>

Case study: factchecking

“We decided to debunk hoaxes in the same format of the hoaxes that had proven so effective at reaching citizens. We decided to try to make the facts as viral as the lies. And it worked.”



El 'show' de la pacífica abuelita al descubierto: es amiga del terrorista Otegi
okdiano

NO.

NO ES LA MISMA SEÑORA.

HEMOS HABLADO CON LA DE LA FOTO DE LA GUARDIA CIVIL.

SE LLAMA FINA, VIVE EN SANT JULIA DE RAMIS.

NO TIENE UNA HERMANA GEMELA.

LA OTRA ES UNA SEÑORA DE BILBAO.



MALDITO BULO

Case study: pollution in Beijing

“People posted photos, selfies, and GIFs to discuss the impacts of pollution on their lives ... [they] were able to cut and paste images and clips [from a censored documentary], disseminating short bits of video and memes or share the entire video file directly. People started conversations online about pollution.”



Intertextuality?

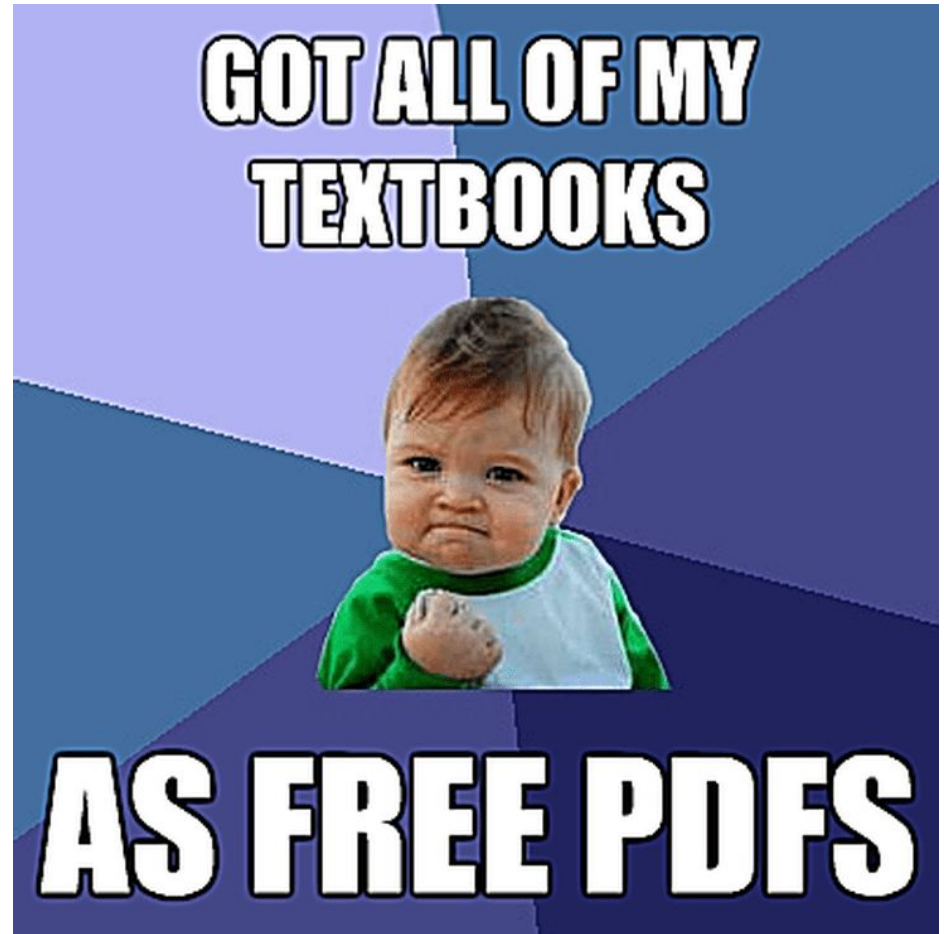


Success Kid / I Hate Sandcastles

Part of a series on Babies. [View Related Entries]

Updated 4 days ago by RandomMan.

Added 8 years ago by Greg McCoral.

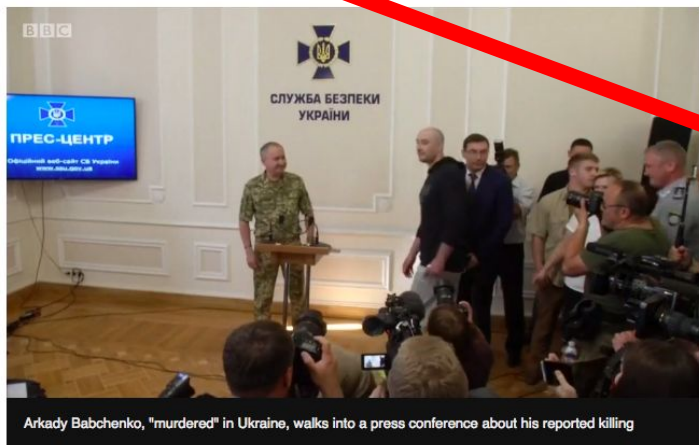


Knowyourmeme: [eggplant meme](#); [success kid](#)

Arkady Babchenko: Ukraine staged fake murder of journalist

15 minutes ago

f t w e Share



Arkady Babchenko, "murdered" in Ukraine, walks into a press conference about his reported killing

Jane Bradley 
@jane__bradley

Follow

This is the first meme I've ever shared but it's a day of firsts so...



4:04 PM - 30 May 2018

482 Retweets 1,609 Likes



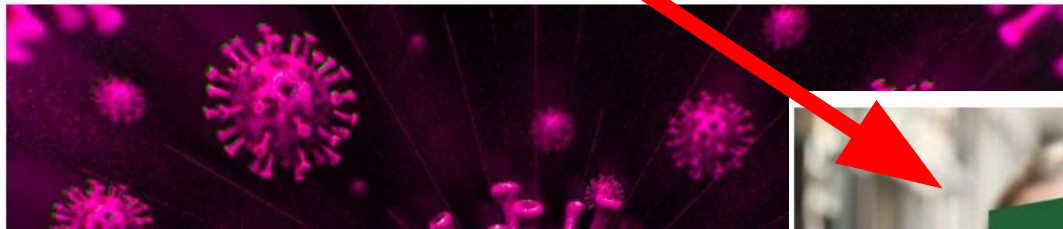
Excel spreadsheet error blamed for UK's 16,000 missing coronavirus cases

The case went missing after the spreadsheet hit its filesize limit

By James Vincent | Oct 5, 2020, 9:41am EDT



SHARE



“A tiny genre of text in itself”

— — —

“Each meme has its own rules and its own grammar ... and is also a kind of game that anyone can join in. And those generally simple rules provide a framework within which each internet meme can be remixed by new participants in new contexts. The rules of each game, each meme, are simple enough to be picked up immediately”

Tip 5:
Try photos + text
or illustration

'Judge Me On My Record,' Says David Cameron. So We Did...

The Huffington Post UK | By Andrea Mann



Posted: 05/01/2015 17:27 GMT | Updated: 06/01/2015 02:59 GMT



"I'm very happy to be judged on the record that I have as Prime Minister"
—David Cameron, 4 January 2015



- One million people using food banks ✓
- Largest A&E department closure in NHS history ✓
- Hundreds of thousands of new insecure and zero hours jobs created ✓
- Bankers' bonuses protected ✓
- Debt higher than under Labour ✓
- Botched Royal Mail sell-off cost tax payers £1bn ✓
- 3.6 million disabled people targeted by spending cuts ✓
- Introduction of the bedroom tax ✓
- Midwives strike for first time in 133 years ✓
- £3bn tax cut for the top one per cent of earners ✓
- 3.5 million children living in poverty - and expected to rise ✓

HUFFPOST UK | BY ANDREA MANN

“Lessons should
be learned.”

David Cameron on the Dumfries
floods, 18 Decem



“Everybody needs to
...learn all the lessons.”

David Cameron on the Somerset

Falling oil prices this
year will cost Russia

\$100bn

More than twice the
impact of economic
sanctions so far at

\$40bn

BBC NEWS



Would you pay
\$3m
for 60lbs of
old lion hide?

(Or **\$2.9m** for
a piano with
Plasticine keys)

BBC NEWS



In eastern Ukraine
13 people
are killed
every day

There have been
957 deaths
since a ceasefire was
called on September 5

BBC NEWS



Pennsv

Sanj
K.



<https://www.journalism.co.uk/news/aesthetic-journalism-brothers-of-the-gun-document-syrian-conflict-with-a-sketchpad-/s2/a729327/>
<https://www.huffingtonpost.co.uk/entry/14-people-told-us-how-they-feel-about-diversity-in-the-city-soon-to-become-majority-non-white>

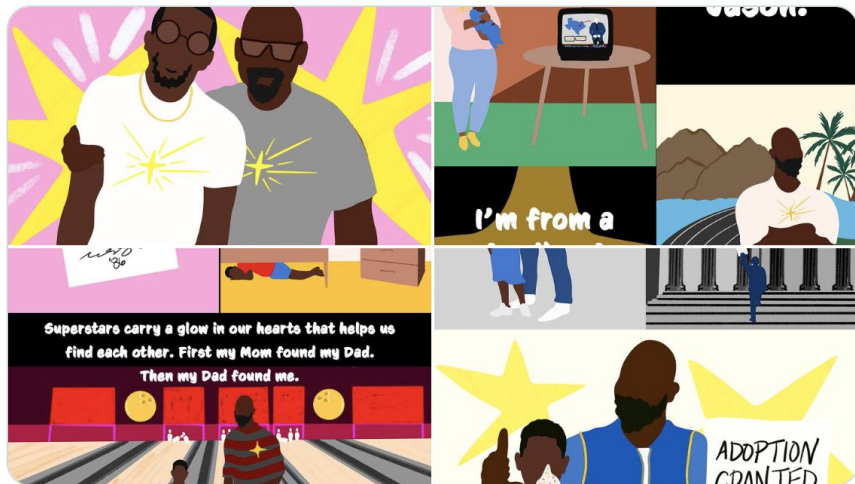


HBO Documentaries ✓
@HBODocs



The Jason & @Karamo Story - illustrated by Shanée Benjamin

40 years ago, the concept of an LGBTQ+ family was inconceivable to most. Today, we celebrate the breadth of queer families. Learn more about how we got here in [#NuclearFamilyDoc](#), streaming now on [@HBOMax](#).



<https://twitter.com/HBODocs/status/1446545524769771521>

b l a n k o n b l a n k

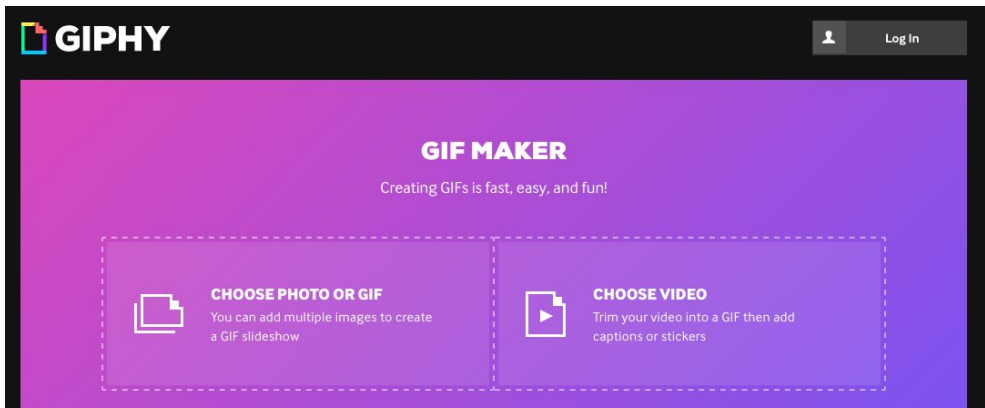
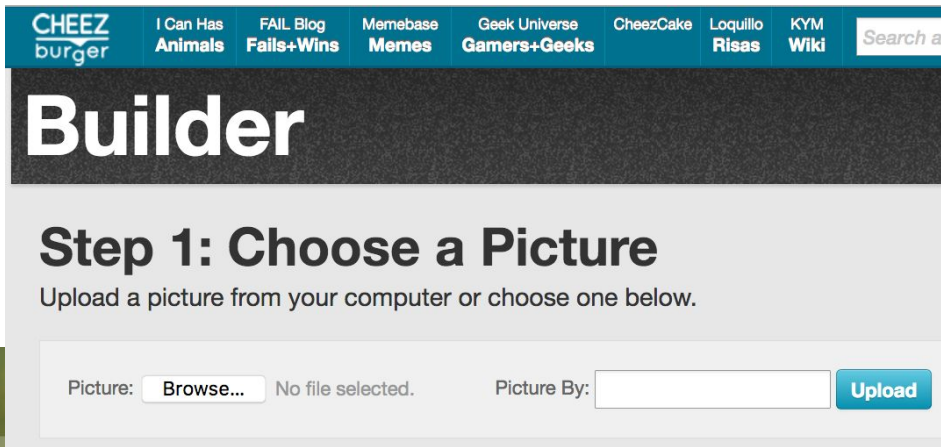
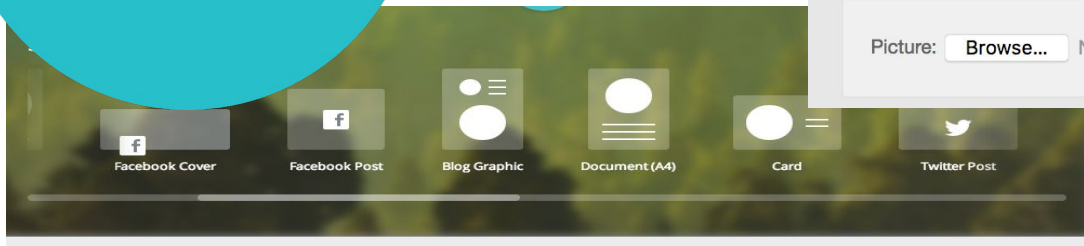
Famous Names, Lost Interviews

THE PBS SERIES



Wayne Coyne on Living with Death

<http://blankonblank.org/>



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